

few commercial properties. He was very active in the local Hundi circuit where people lent each other unsecured loans for as much as 25 per cent per annum on an annualized basis (without declaring anything to the taxman).

Over the years, Mr Sanghvi had had multiple trysts with the stock market. He was a punter by nature and liked making aggressive bets. In fact, Mr Sanghvi dealt in the Futures and Options market and took leveraged positions in stocks. At the peak of the Bull cycle in January 2008, he was worth Rs 150 crore, but by November 2008 his net worth had fallen so much that he was teetering on the brink of bankruptcy, all thanks to the margin calls that his brokers had made on him. He had sworn to never make that mistake again and hence missed out on the 145 per cent rally in the Nifty between March 2009 and November 2010. Seeing his friends make money over that period had made Mr Sanghvi envious. So, when Narendra Modi took over as the Prime Minister of India in May 2014, Mr Sanghvi decided it was high time that he reentered the markets.

That was then. Now, with the business liquidated and the dividends gone, Mr Sanghvi was scratching his head to figure out how to finance the rest of his retirement, his family's lifestyle and his children's education on a paltry corpus of Rs 25 crore.

Mr Sanghvi's life chart: A typical small business owner's lifeline

